

Friday, 22 May 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

28° 17°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

26° 14°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

25° 16°

GLASGOW

Light drizzle

19° 14°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

People in Britain can't afford a good life, Burnham says.

Andy Burnham was speaking in a series of interviews with the candidates for the Makerfield by-election.

POLITICS · UK

2

Race Across the World pals Jo and Kush on fame, friendship and family.

The childhood best friends from Liverpool are the youngest duo in this series of the BBC show.

UK · NEWS

3

Why illegal children's homes are being paid up to £2m per child by councils.

A ban was meant to bring an end to the practice - but councils continue to fund illegal placements.

UK · NEWS

02 – SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

- 1 BBC confirms new Strictly Come Dancing hosts.**
The trio replace Tess Daly and Claudia Winkleman, who left the BBC dance competition last year.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 2 Shakira wins £50m tax refund from Spanish government.**
The Colombian singer says the court ruling means the "narrative" that she was guilty now "crumbles".
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 3 New BBC boss warns that 'tough choices are unavoidable'.**
Ex-Google executive Matt Brittin says the BBC has "never been more needed" but faces "very real challenges".
SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

1

'I wanted emotional rollercoaster'- Prince William on supporting Villa.

Prince William tells BBC Sport's Gary Lineker why he started supporting Aston Villa.

SPORT · UK

2

Capsey stars as England ease past New Zealand in first T20.

Alice Capsey hits an unbeaten 74 to help England chase down 137 in Derby, securing a seven-wicket win against New Zealand in the first of their three-match T20 series.

SPORT · UK

3

'Not a fake fight' - Usyk on Verhoeven & helping Joshua.

Oleksandr Usyk says he is training with the "same intensity" as always for Saturday's fight against Rico Verhoeven.

SPORT · UK

4

Abuse complaints process to be replaced after victims' criticism.

British Gymnastics says it will replace its complaints process after concerns over the treatment of gymnasts - following criticism from abuse victims.

SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Almost 70% of UK households now have a smart speaker — but the most common use is still 'asking what time it is'.**
Researchers say we under-use the devices we own. Setting timers, playing music and weather queries make up two thirds of all commands.
- 2 Brits now spend an average of 14 hours a week on streaming — more than cooking, cleaning and exercising combined.**
The biggest jump is in the over-55s, who used to be the holdouts for live telly. 'Second-screening' means we pay less attention than ever.
- 3 Pubs report a Tuesday boom — the new 'mid-week meet' is the fastest-growing dining occasion.**
Operators say WFH-ers like getting out the house mid-week without the weekend crowds. Tuesday wine sales are up almost 30%.
- 4 The average Brit checks their phone 159 times a day — but says it 'doesn't feel like that much'.**
Researchers using passive monitoring apps say we badly underestimate our own usage. Most people guess between 30 and 70 times.
- 5 Half of UK adults can't name a single member of the cabinet — but 80% can name three Love Island contestants.**
Political engagement researchers say it's not apathy so much as 'noise overload'. People remember faces from things they actively watch.
- 6 More than half of UK workers would take a 10% pay cut to never go into the office again — but only 17% of bosses say they'd offer one.**
The gap is growing again after forced return-to-office rules. HR experts say the tension shows up in resignation rates, particularly for under-35s.
- 7 Britain's most-stolen supermarket item in 2026 isn't meat or cheese — it's olive oil, with theft up 220% year on year.**
Prices have nearly doubled in two years. Some shops have fitted security tags to single bottles, others have moved premium brands behind the counter — like cigarettes.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 57% of UK workers admit doing THIS while on a work call. What?

ANSWER: GOING TO THE LOO.

Q Asked what makes them feel old, the top answer wasn't grey hairs — it was THIS. What?

ANSWER: NOT RECOGNISING ANY OF THE NAMES AT THE TOP OF THE CHARTS.

TALK TOPIC

- **A new study says we form a strong opinion of someone within 7 seconds of meeting them.**
Talk-back: what's the quickest you've ever decided you didn't like someone — and were you right? Or the quickest you DID like someone?
- **Matching pet-and-owner outfits are apparently making a comeback this summer.**
Would you actually do it? And if so — does the dog get a vote in the wardrobe?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Tech.** A start-up has invented a wearable that gently vibrates to remind you to drink water — and reportedly raised £3 million in two days on Kickstarter.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Researchers at Manchester University have built an AI that can predict which biscuit you'll dunk in your tea next, based only on the way you hold the mug.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£10.75 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£10.75 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The colour orange is named after the fruit, not the other way around.
- More people speak English in China than in the United States.
- Cleopatra lived closer in time to the moon landing than to the building of the Great Pyramid.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time — 1/100th of a second.
- Goats have rectangular pupils, which gives them nearly 360-degree vision.
- Lightning strikes Earth about 100 times every second.
- Bees have to visit roughly 2 million flowers to make one pound of honey.
- Mosquitoes are attracted to people who've just eaten bananas.

On this day

Day 142 of the year, 223 days left in 2026. Today Abolition Day (Martinique); Aromanian National Day (marginal, celebration on May 23 is more common); Christian feast day: Castus and Emilius; Christian feast day: Fulk. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Emerald.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1938 — Susan Strasberg, American actress (died 1999)
- 1974 — Sean Gunn, American actor
- 1992 — Anna Baryshnikov, American actress
- 1938 — Richard Benjamin, American actor and director
- 1979 — Nazanin Boniadi, Iranian-American actress
- 2004 — Peyton Elizabeth Lee, American actress
- 1940 — Kieth Merrill, American filmmaker
- 1966 — Johnny Gill, American singer-songwriter and producer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1972 — Ceylon adopts a new constitution, becoming a republic and changing its name to Sri Lanka.
- 2002 — Civil rights movement: A jury in Birmingham, Alabama, convicts former Ku Klux Klan member Bobby Frank Cherry of the 1963 murder of four girls in the 16th Street Baptist Church bombing.
- 2014 — An explosion occurs in Ürümqi, capital of China's far-western Xinjiang region, resulting in at least 43 deaths and 91 injuries.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1969 — Apollo 10's Lunar Module flies within 8.4 nautical miles (16 km) of the Moon's surface.
- 2014 — General Prayut Chan-o-cha becomes interim leader of Thailand in a military coup d'état, following six months of political turmoil.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1972 — Ceylon adopts a new constitution, becoming a republic and changing its name to Sri Lanka.
- 1972 — Over 400 women in Derry, Northern Ireland attack the offices of Sinn Féin following the shooting by the Irish Republican Army of a young British soldier on leave.

- 2014 — An explosion occurs in Ürümqi, capital of China's far-western Xinjiang region, resulting in at least 43 deaths and 91 injuries.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 143 of the year, 222 days left in 2026. Today Aromanian National Day; Christian feast day: Aaron the Illustrious (Syriac Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Desiderius of Vienne; Christian feast day: Giovanni Battista de' Rossi. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Emerald.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1955 — Luka Bloom, Irish singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1918 — Denis Compton, English cricketer and sportscaster (died 1997)
- 1958 — Lea DeLaria, American actress and singer
- 1985 — Ross Wallace, Scottish footballer
- 1990 — Dan Evans, British tennis player
- 1936 — Charles Kimbrough, American actor (died 2023)
- 1997 — Maximilian Kilman, English footballer
- 1966 — Graeme Hick, Zimbabwean-English cricketer and coach

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1995 — The first version of the Java programming language is released.
- 2022 — Anthony Albanese of the Australian Labor Party is sworn in as the 31st Prime Minister of Australia after winning the 2022 Australian federal election, ending 9 years of conservative rule.
- 1951 — Tibetans sign the Seventeen Point Agreement with China.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2021 — Ryanair Flight 4978 is forced to land by Belarusian authorities to detain dissident journalist Roman Protasevich.
- 1980 — The Shining, the psychological horror film directed by Stanley Kubrick, is premiered on 10 screens in New York City and Los Angeles on the Memorial Day weekend.

Coming to cinemas

MAY 2026	
FRI 15	Mortal Kombat II (+ IMAX); Is God Is; Poetic License
FRI 22	The Mandalorian and Grogu (+ IMAX)
JUNE 2026	
FRI 5	Masters of the Universe; Power Ballad
FRI 12	Scary Movie 6; new Spielberg film (+ IMAX)
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life
JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

MAY 2026		JULY 2026	
THU 14	PGA Championship begins (Golf)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
WED 20	UEFA Europa League Final	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
SAT 23	EFL Championship Play-off Final, Wembley	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
SUN 24	Premier League final day (all 10 games, 3pm BST)	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
24 MAY – 7 JUN	French Open (Tennis)	23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
THU 28	Premier League Darts Finals Night	AUGUST 2026	
SAT 30	UEFA Champions League Final	W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
JUNE 2026		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
THU 4	NBA Finals begin	22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)		
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts		
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)		
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)		
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon		